

Contract Review Checklist

Before you sign

A contract can allocate money, risk, deadlines, and ownership. Read every page and identify the law and forum that apply. The Contract Act, 1872 remains a core reference, subject to later legislation.

- Confirm every party's legal name, authority, address, and identity.
- Check that schedules, specifications, prices, and referenced policies are attached.
- Never sign a blank page or rely on a promise that is not written.

Commercial terms

Make the deal measurable

Ambiguous price, scope, delivery, acceptance, and payment terms create disputes.

- Define deliverables, milestones, taxes, currency, invoices, and late-payment consequences.
- State who bears shipping, insurance, approvals, and change-order costs.
- Include a process for variations, notices, and recordkeeping.

Risk and remedies

Plan for problems

Review warranties, indemnities, liability caps, insurance, confidentiality, and intellectual-property ownership.

- Check whether exclusions are mutual and whether a cap has sensible exceptions.
- Identify termination triggers, cure periods, return of property, and survival clauses.
- Ensure dispute escalation, jurisdiction, and governing law are workable.

Signing and performance

Keep an audit trail

Authority and execution formalities matter. Some transactions require witnesses, registration, stamping, or notarisation.

- Confirm the signatory's board resolution, power of attorney, or other authority.
- Keep the signed version, amendments, invoices, approvals, and delivery evidence together.
- Calendar renewal, notice, warranty, and limitation dates.

Official source and reminder

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- Pakistan Code, Contract Act, 1872:

<https://pakistancode.gov.pk/english/UY2FqaJw1-apaUY2Fqa-apaUY2Npa5tmaQ%253D%253D-sg-jjjjjjjjjjjjj>

The Contract Act is not a substitute for transaction-specific review. Obtain qualified advice for high-value, regulated, or cross-border agreements.